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IAN THOMAS WHITE

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COMPUTATIONAL LINGUIST & WRITER

Website

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Linkedin

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ianthomaswhite@gmail.com

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515-508-9805

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Los Angeles (open to relocation)

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OVERVIEW

I am an academically trained linguist with substantial tech-industry experience. I have training in all linguistic subfields, with a focus on formal language theory, and I've leveraged my linguistics training at ML/AI companies. I'm a rigorous problem-solver across both quantitative (Python, SQL, Haskell) and qualitative (writing, annotation, ontology) domains.

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PROFICIENCIES

PROGRAMMING	LINGUISTICS	LANGUAGES	SKILLS
Git, Haskell, JSON, $\LaTeX$, Markdown, MS 365, NLTK, Notion, Python, PyTorch, Prompt Engineering, R, SQL	Computational, Grammar, Lexical, Morphology, NLP, Phonology, Pragmatics, Semantics, Syntax	French, Greek (Ancient), Latin (Classical)	Communication, Data Analysis & Annotation, Ontology, Research, Statistics, Taxonomy, Technical Writing

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EXPERIENCE

- LINGUISTICS TRAINER AND QA SPECIALIST, HUMAN DATA @ SpaceXAI: 08.2024-08.2026
- Annotated textual and visual/audio LLM outputs for adherence to phonological, syntactical, and semantic norms.
 - Conducted model evaluation and QA for Python and SQL outputs.
 - Wrote novel guidance and QA rubrics in Markdown, JSON, and Excel.
 - Collaborated with engineers to ensure labeling guidelines accorded with machine learning principles and goals.
 - Trained new tutors and developed algorithmic processes to improve tutor workflow and inter-annotator agreement.
- LINGUISTICS INSTRUCTOR @ UCLA: 09.2022-12.2023
- Taught weekly seminars covering major linguistic subfields: phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics, pragmatics.
 - Developed unique teaching materials and technical documentation using $\LaTeX$ and Haskell.
 - Evaluated student performance and conducted regular one-on-one meetings with students.
- COMPUTATIONAL LINGUIST @ App Orchid: 06.2021-09.2022
- Designed syntactic-tree-based regexes to match complex, embedded legal phrases in an LLM pipeline.
 - Labeled and taxonomized linguistic regularities in legal corpora for POS, NER, and dependency/constituency parsing.
 - Researched string parsing techniques to optimize regex search algorithms.
 - Integrated regexes into the LLM pipeline using Python, SQL, and Git and wrote accompanying technical documentation.
 - Communicated regularly with engineers, clients, and other stakeholders to ensure optimal ML outcomes.
- LITERATURE INSTRUCTOR @ University of Minnesota: 09.2016-05.2020
- Designed and implemented syllabi for key departmental courses on literary theory.
 - Wrote from scratch unique teaching materials on grammar and rhetoric.

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EDUCATION

- PHD (INCOMPLETE), LINGUISTICS @ UCLA: 2020-2023
- Took graduate courses in all linguistic subfields, as well as in algorithms and formal language theory.
 - Researched and wrote on the generative capacities of Combinatory Categorical Grammars and Minimalist Grammars.
 - Applied research toward NLP/NLU applications using Python and Haskell.
- MA, LINGUISTICS @ University of Minnesota: 2016-2020
- Thesis: "The Argument Structure of Deverbal Nouns".
 - Took graduate courses in all linguistic subfields: phonology, syntax, semantics, pragmatics, computational.
 - Completed corpora analysis projects using Python, NLTK, and Google Colab.
- MA, LITERATURE @ University of Minnesota: 2016-2020
- Thesis: "Discrete Infinity in Penelope's Weaving Trick".
 - Took graduate courses in literary theory, French-language poetry, and Greek-language literature.
 - Used APA, MLA, and Chicago manuals of style to write papers.
- BA, WRITING @ Johns Hopkins University: 2008-2011
- Thesis: "Modern Mimesis: Alt-lit and Autofiction".